

FEELING VERSUS DOING

How and Why to start the Brain's Creative Mode?

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WHY?

Does it help me?

In a world with a huge volume of “blah blah” information, what matters the most? It is our ability to **easily** and **rapidly scan** information to answer the question: **“**Does it help me?”.
If the answer is no -> discard the information, don't clutter your brain.
If the answer is yes -> read, learn, apply, and repeat it until you know it by heart and it becomes an automated habit that improves your life.

This article offers you:

- **A structure** that is easy to understand and learn
- **Examples** and **questions** that push you to develop a Creative Mindset and train you to make decisions on your own
- A bit of **humor** to relax your brain

I feel like a giant to-do list

This morning, the first thought that crossed my mind when I woke up was, **“What are you going to do today?”.** I immediately began listing all the activities I had to get done.

I realized just what an important place the “to-do list” occupied in my life. The very first thought of a human being who had just opened their eyes and pressed the brain's Start button went straight there — to the tasks ahead.

There had to be another way — a calmer and more peaceful way to live. I often felt overwhelmed by the things I “had” to do.
Theoretically, I know that all of us are valuable simply because we exist. But what I was feeling inside was completely different.
If I was a priceless human being, **why did I feel like a giant to-do list**? Did society only care about tagging me with the value of my Productivity?

How do I want to feel?

As I continued my morning routine, I wondered: what if I replaced that first question with a new one?

“How do I want to feel?”
“I want to feel joy and enthusiasm”, I replied to myself.

The concept of Human Doing includes all our daily actions, tasks, activities, and responsibilities. Looking at our lives as human beings, we realize how much the Human Doing weighs on us. So much so that society often puts an equal sign between our inherent value and our Human Doing. And I noticed that I internalized this message.

- Am I the sum of all my actions?
- Is my value determined by my actions' success?
- Must every action be successful to increase my worth?
- And if my actions are not successful, what is my worth?

Those were the questions that wandered through my head, giving me an unpleasant feeling of fear mixed with high stress.

I wondered: **what is the pleasure, joy, and satisfaction in doing hundreds of activities** validated as success?
What was **the gain for me**?
Because even if I could check off everything on the success list, I could still end up unhappy.

- And if the activities and actions I did were not the answer, what was?
- **What if it’s not so important what and how much we do?**
- What if the Feeling we have when performing any action mattered more?

In a simpler way, let’s think about this together: If two people perform the same actions — work, write, read, drive — but with different feelings (one is calm and feels joy, while the other is angry and sad), do you think their results will be the same? I think not.

- If stressing out over making every action a success brings me to burnout, why not change the strategy?
- What if, instead of focusing on what we do, we change our attention to **what we feel** when doing that activity?

And why is it so important what we feel when doing an activity? Because there is a huge difference between a Created Feeling and an Automatic Feeling.

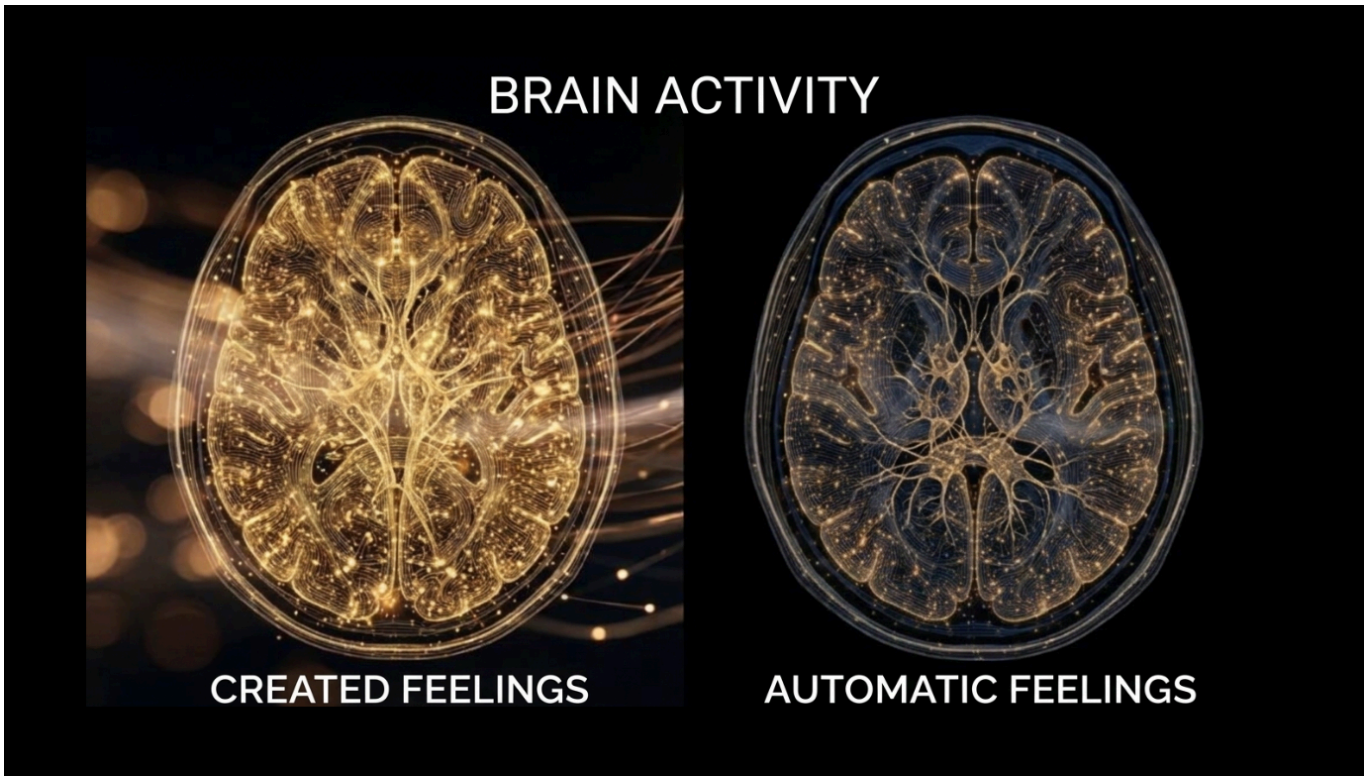
Examples of Created Feelings: joy, enthusiasm, happiness, pleasure, excitement, curiosity, satisfaction, pride, safety, gratitude, amusement, love, wonder.
Automatic Feelings: fear, worry, stress, anxiety, sadness, rage, frustration, unworthiness, hopelessness.
Let’s dive a little deeper to really understand the 2 categories of feelings.

Automatic Feelings

Why did I use the term “automatic” to describe them? Because I noticed when I was exposed to an unpleasant external event they happen involuntarily, instantly, and without conscious effort within my Brain. They were like a reaction that I couldn’t control.
Also, I realized that usually, when I felt an Automatic Feeling, like sadness for example, they tended to pile up — meaning other feelings in the same range continued to show up, like a snowball that just grew and grew.

Created Feelings

Why did I use the term “created” to describe them? Because I observed that there were far fewer situations when they spontaneously appeared. It was harder to feel them and they faded faster. And I thought, if they are not automatic and it’s harder for them to appear on their own, why not deliberately create them?



The **vital** difference between them is that Created Feelings have a **superpower** to trigger the mind's **Creative Mode**, while Automatic Feelings have quite the opposite effect. When our human brain is in Creative Mode, we are flooded with its Beneficial Side Effects.

The idea that a Created Feeling, like joy, could switch "on" the start button for my brain's Creative Mode sounded marvelous. And it wasn't about gaining a fashionable, "must-have" Brain Mode; I saw an opportunity to add to my life.

The Brain

Now, who's the brain? The brain is our best friend.

Did you know that our brain is a genius? It is really good at fulfilling multiple tasks, many of them quite vital. It is indeed a priceless friend, very good when it comes to collaborating with you.

But there is a little secret you have to know in order to understand its way of operating. Imagine it is the CEO of our body, and one of its most important responsibilities is to allocate our body's Energy. Each organ, cognitive action, physical activity, and habit that we undertake "burns" a certain amount of our Total Body Energy (TBE).
So guess who makes the calls when deciding where the Energy goes?
I thought it was me. 🙂

One day I had the idea to increase my physical activity time and adopt a new habit of exercising 30 minutes daily.
A quite easy and reasonable goal, I thought.
But after trying three times, I noticed that within 4, 7, or 10 days I was quitting.
I kept failing at "installing" this new habit.

How hard can it be to start a simple new routine, to exercise 30 minutes a day? I kept asking myself with anger.
But most importantly, why am I not succeeding in doing it?

I noticed when somebody asked me, "How is it going with your exercises?" my answer was: "I quit. I really don't have 30 minutes a day to practice."
Now, do you remember the Brain? Could it give me 30 minutes from its Energy reserves for my new habit?

Energy and Habits

Let's see together the link between Energy and Habits.
There are **Old Habits** and **New Habits**. For each Old Habit, the amount of Energy spent is less because they have been automated.

For example: eating, walking, driving, reading, etc. For an already learned process, it is logical that fewer cognitive and body actions are involved, meaning less energy consumption.

This way of thinking is beneficial and gives us the opportunity to fulfill our daily activities with the least amount of energy needed for each process. This is the daily agenda: every part of our body knows its job and everything goes smoothly.

A **New Habit** requires **higher** volumes of **Energy**. Naturally, the **Brain** wants to make calculated, **wise decisions**. That's why it is a “little” reserved when starting new actions.

One day, I was browsing on social media and I saw a clip which had a background song. That song had awakened in me the desire to go out and walk in nature. The song was The Weeknd - Save Your Tears.

This song gave me the idea to walk while listening to music. Genius, right? Like no one in the history of the world had ever thought of doing that. 🙂
An old and well-known idea: mixing music and physical exercise. And yet, I was still struggling to work out 30 minutes a day.

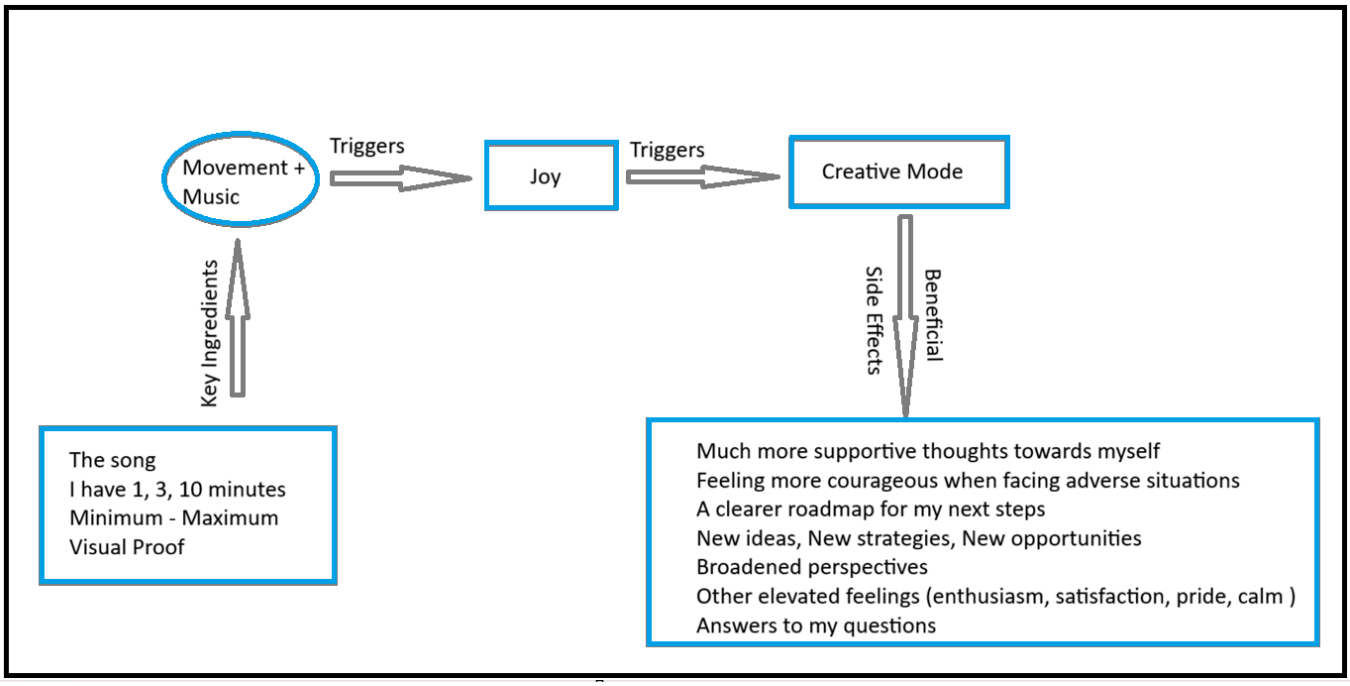
I want to Feel Joy

But this was just the theoretical part. The hard part was finding a way to apply this idea into my real life.
I kept asking myself:

- How could I install a Created Feeling that could trigger my Creative Mode?
- Will adopting a Created Feeling (e.g., Joy) trigger my Brain to switch into Creative Mode?
- And will this Creative Mode have Beneficial Side Effects (e.g., a clear mind, answers to questions, new opportunities, new strategies, etc.)?

But how do we achieve a Created Feeling?
Through music and movement.
That simple?
Yes!

Take a look at the diagram below. This is the visual representation of my idea, and it is a key piece to remember. For quick and easy access later, take a screenshot and save it to your phone.



From the classical perspective, I really think that Motivation arises from Pure Brain Logic. But opening the **Creative Mode gives** you something beyond Motivation, at a way higher level, that's why I like to use the term **"Rocket Fuel"** to describe it.
By raising our Energy through movement and music, our brain offers us a wide variety of benefits that we could never have obtained through Pure Brain Logic alone.

Some of the Beneficial Side Effects that I experienced in my Brain's Creative Mode are:

- Feeling joy more often
- Much more supportive thoughts towards myself
- Feeling real enthusiasm about continuing to work toward my dreams and personal projects, despite my own failures, despite periods of fatigue, despite the discouragement from those around me, and despite the fear generated by the current global context
- Feeling more courageous when facing situations that used to be challenges for me
- Feeling proud of my work and my daily progress
- Catching myself adopting a straighter posture when walking down the street
- An increased capacity for observation
- A clearer roadmap for my next steps
- New ideas, New strategies, New opportunities
- Broadened perspectives
- Other Created feelings
- More positive thoughts
- Answers to my questions

HOW?

Now let's translate all the theory into practice and answer the question ''How?''.
In this section, I present all the practical steps I took and their key ingredients.
I kept it clean and easy to follow, making it really simple to learn.

The song

- The Rhythm and Melody: I choose **high-energy tracks** that make me want to move, bypassing slow melodies. I notice the melody matters far more than the lyrics.
- The Emotional Effect: I select **songs** that **I genuinely love** — ones capable of triggering a powerful emotional response inside me.
- The Renewal: After a while, if I notice that a melody no longer sparks an emotion, I instantly **replace** it with a fresh one.
- The Choice of Language: I choose songs in English and Spanish because I love how they sound. Also, I deliberately **avoid** my **native language** to prevent my brain from switching into Analytical Mode the moment it processes the words.
  Even though I have an intermediate proficiency in English and a beginner-level in Spanish, I notice my brain only tracks about 5-10% of the actual lyrics. This allows me to remain completely anchored in feeling rather than analyzing the text.

This is my list of songs if you want to use it as a model:

- The Weekend - Save your tears
- The Weekend ft Dua Lipa - Let me with you (remix)
- The Weeknd Ft. Dua Lipa - One Last Time (remix)
- Alba Leticia - Sé esa mujer valiente
- Vibra Eterna - Renazco en mí

I have 1, 3, 10 minutes

As we discussed before, our brilliant Brain is designed to conserve the Total Body Energy (TBE) that's why it selects thoughts and habits it already knows.

As soon as we want to acquire a new habit, its natural and logical response is: "I don't have time!".

What did I do to override this command? I replaced that thought with another: "I have [...] minutes to do my physical exercises while listening to music."

For example, one morning it was 8:30 a.m. and I had to leave the house at 8:40 a.m., I told myself: “I have 10 minutes to dance”.
Do you notice the difference between “I have 1 minute”,”I have 3 minutes”, “I have 10 minutes” etc versus “I don't have time”?

Minimum - Maximum

My starting point: I took between 2,000 and 4,000 steps while doing my daily tasks. I was rather sedentary and did not do any other physical activity.

My hierarchy of goals

Minimum goals:

- Ridiculously small goal, impossible to fail: stand in front of the mirror (where I practice my movements) for 1 second ➔ Success
- Dance for 3 minutes (1 song) ➔ Success
- Dance for 10 minutes (3 songs) ➔ Success

Medium goals:

- 10 minutes of dancing + walking in nature = 5,000 steps ➔ Success
- 30 minutes of dancing + walking in nature = 10,000 steps ➔ Success (This is my favorite goal)

Maximum goals:

- 60 minutes of dancing + 7,000 steps ➔ Success
- 60 minutes of dancing + 10,000 steps ➔ Success
- 12,000 steps ➔ Success
- 14,000 steps ➔ Success

The assessment after 6 months:
After 6 months of putting this into practice, I concluded that:

- 5% of the days, I reached the minimum objective;
- 75% of the days, I reached the average objectives;
- 20% of the days, I reached the maximum objectives.
- And there’s even more. Do you know what my rate of returning to a habit after a break was? Exactly 0% — once I stopped, I quit for good.
  But after implementing these steps, do you know what that bounce-back rate became? 100%.
  Somehow, I successfully restarted the habit every single time — even after a full two-week break.

Another crucial part is: our Success Definition. Do you notice what a **broad perspective of success** I adopted?

Guess how it impacted my Brain?

My **Brain registered** that it was **winning every** single **day**. Achieving a goal daily — thanks to this diverse range of objectives — was highly beneficial for my mind.
It made me feel great and helped me stay consistent in my daily progress.

Visual Proof

I bought a smartwatch to accurately measure my activity.
Visibly tracking my progress has helped me tremendously.
For example: Look at the image below. One day, I danced for 30 minutes, and my watch shows 2,819 steps. My Brain just registered a **visual** image, a **proof** of its success.



The Ripple Effect

Now, looking back, I am able to connect the dots. What I achieved is the perfect example of a **ripple effect:**

It started with a song -> that made me walk in nature.



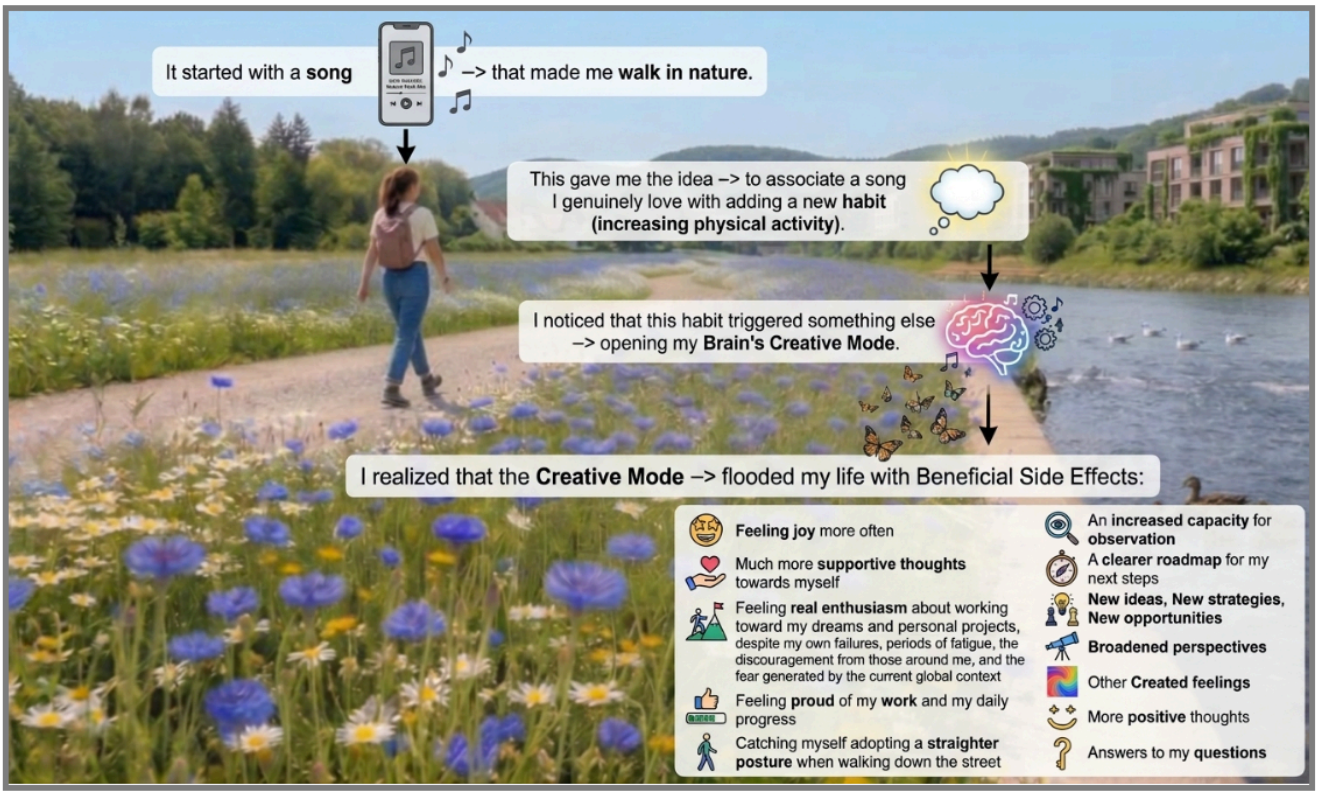
This gave me the idea -> to associate a song I genuinely love with adding a new habit (increasing physical activity).



I noticed that this habit triggered something else -> opening my Brain's Creative Mode.



I realized that the Creative Mode -> flooded my life with Beneficial Side Effects.



FEELING VERSUS DOING

When my life moves too fast and overwhelm sets in, I stop and ask, **“What is my focus?”.**
My internal answer is always: **"Practice feeling joy daily** through the fusion of movement with music”.
When we vibrate in a heightened State of Mind, the rest of life automatically falls into place.

And very importantly, do it for you, start with you. If each of us focuses on installing our own Creative Mode, the entire community benefits as a natural side effect. **The focus is on you** learning to feel joy inside. The focus is not on the Others, nor on the Beneficial Side Effects.

We, as humans, are not a Product on a factory assembly line.
The attention as a Human Being should not be to become the Perfect Most Highly Productive Successful Product. Because this road surely leads to burnout, frustration, fear, and high stress, I walked down it.

It is not the huge volume of completed tasks that gives us pleasure, joy, and satisfaction, but the inner feeling we experience while doing all these tasks. It doesn’t even matter what tasks we choose to do, all that matters is that we feel joy.

And to verify this idea, I invite you to experiment with it and reach your own answers. If it doesn’t work for you, remember you have the delete button for useless information. And restart searching for something else that could add to your life.
Let’s **choose** only **helpful** and useful information which returns a ‘’Yes” to this question – **“Does it help me?’’**

If I had to summarize my article in 1 sentence:
Use Movement + Music to Feel Joy that opens Creative Mode.

If I had to summarize my article in 1 word:
Feeling